Food Chains

Use the words below to fill in the gaps in the sentences about food chains.

Herbivores Green plants Water Secondary Dogs
Bacteria Photosynthesis Arrows Energy source
Rabbits Carbon dioxide Consumers Carnivores
Decomposers Producers Primary

A food chain is a sequence of who eats whom in a biological community. It starts with an _____ _____ , like the sun. The _____ in the chain show the flow of food energy.

Every community must have a food source, which is made by organisms called _____ . Most producers are _____ _____ , such as flowering plants, moss and algae.

Producers make food using a process called _____ . The plants use the energy from the sun to change _____ _____ and _____ into a sugar called glucose.

Organisms that require a ready-made source of food are called - _____ . Animals that eat producers are called _____ consumers, or _____ . Some examples are _____ and cows.

Animals that eat other animals are called _____ consumers or _____ . Some examples are lions and _____ .

Fungi and _____ are organisms that break down wastes and dead bodies. These organisms are called _____.

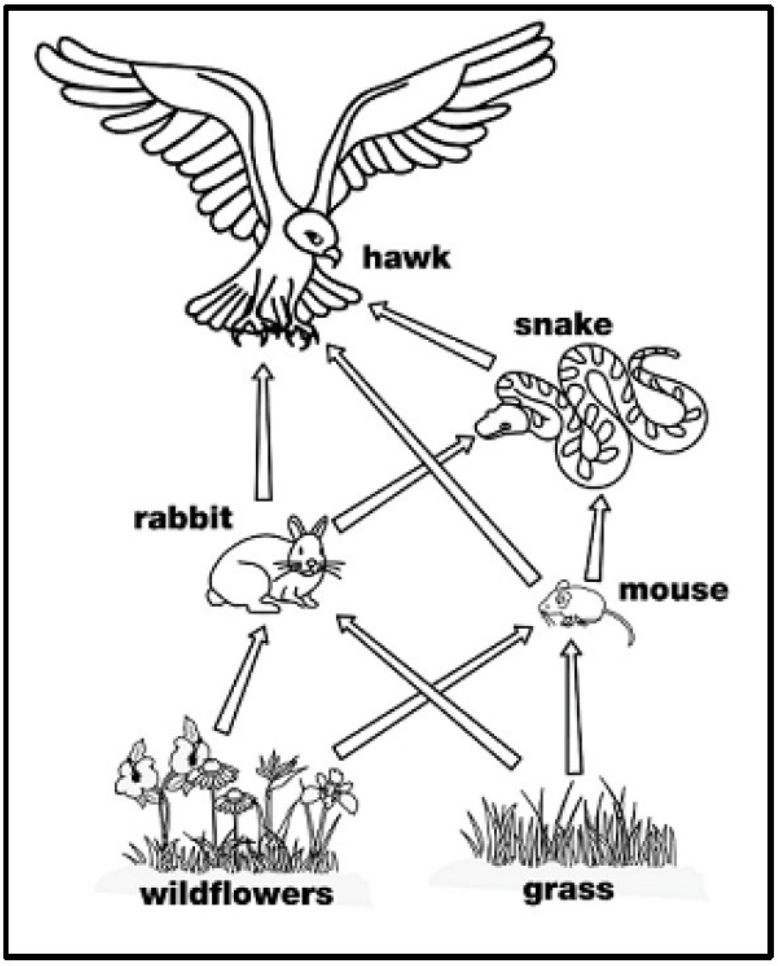
Use the food chain below to answer the questions.



1. Identify the herbivore.
2. What is the energy source?
3. Which animal is the secondary consumer?
4. Which organism is the producer?
5. Identify the primary consumer?
6. Which organism is the carnivore

Food Webs

There are many food chains in communities and they are all interconnected. All the connected food chains are known as a **food web**. Food webs are usually complex, with each organism appearing in many food chains.



1. Name the living things in the food web that are producers.
2. List the primary consumers in the food web.
3. Name the secondary consumers in the food web.
4. There are many food chains in this food web. One chain with four levels is shown below.

   Wildflowers → Mouse → Snake → Hawk

   Draw three more food chains, one with three levels and two with four levels.

Drawing Food Webs

Draw the following food webs. You can use words only or include pictures in your webs. Draw arrows between the organisms to show how the energy flows through the food web.

Web 1

- Grass provides food for snails and rabbits.
- Rabbits are eaten by foxes and snakes.
- The snails are eaten by birds.
- Birds, rabbits and snakes can be eaten by hawks.

Web 2

- Grass is eaten by a number of animals including rabbits, grasshoppers and mice.
- Grass hoppers provide a great meal for toads, mice, sparrows and snakes.
- Hawks feed on rabbits, sparrows and snakes.

Web 3

- In a pond, algae grow on rocks, which are eaten by water snails.
- The water snails are eaten by small fish, which also eat water plants.
- Large fish feed on both the snails and the small fish.

Web 4

- Trees produce acorns which act as a food for many mice and insects.
- Because there are many mice, the weasels and snakes have food.
- The insects and the acorns also attract birds and possums.
- With the possums, weasels and mice around, hawks, foxes and owls can find food.

Web 5

- Krill are small shellfish which live in the ocean.
- Krill are eaten by seals and fish.
- Seals are eaten by arctic wolves and polar bears.
- Polar bears also eat fish.